Those three factors are very hard, though not impossible, to detect in our own time. The vast majority of Jews live without antisemitic legislation, and with full civil and political rights. To be exact, this status is not completely universal. There are smaller Jewish communities living in countries like Venezuela, Hungary, Turkey, and Iran, where antisemitic sentiments are stoked, or in other ways encouraged, by governments and political leaders. And there are regimes who manipulate the charge of antisemitism for their own political ends—the most pertinent example can be seen in Vladmir Putin's invocation of right-wing Ukrainian antisemitism as a partial justification for the invasion of Ukraine in 2014.[4]

Most significantly, there is a Jewish state that provides sanctuary to Jews facing threats to their security. It is a state that is reassuringly capable of protecting the Jews who live there, as citizens of Israel, from external aggression. Moreover, under the "Law of Return" passed by the Knesset, Israel's parliament, on July 5, 1950, "[E]very Jew has the right to come to this country as an *oleh*"—a Hebrew term for a new Jewish citizen of Israel. This measure, perhaps more than any other, represents the link between the legacy of the Holocaust and the existential purpose of the State of Israel: to ensure that no Jew will, in future, be persecuted on the grounds of ethnicity, religious belief, political sympathies, or any of the other pretexts that have been mobilized by antisemitic movements.

The parameters defining Jewish existence today are not those of a zero-sum game: empowerment does not eliminate prejudice, nor does prejudice render empowerment without significance. In the age of Jewish empowerment, then, antisemitism persists with a disarming slipperiness. For some, it is frighteningly concrete, a reminder of the observation made by Max Nordau to the first Zionist Congress in 1897, that Jewish "emancipation should first have been completed in sentiment before it was declared by law."[5] But a broad swath of opinion, surveying the transformations of Jewish existence brought about after 1945, remains unconvinced that there is a problem to begin with; or, if there is one, that it will be resolved once there is a final settlement of the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, which is regarded by many as the principal cause of global antisemitism.

Crucially, the broad empirical truths of Jewish existence now—successful integration in democratic societies, in addition to the option of living under Jewish sovereignty—have led some analysts to question the continuing relevance of "antisemitism" as a descriptor. For example, Anshel Pfeffer, widely respected as a level-headed and sober contributor to the liberal Israeli daily, *Haaretz*, wrote in February 2014:

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